Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K Q 9 8 3 ♥ 2 ♦ A K ♣ K Q J 8	
♠ 10 5 ♥ 8 6 3 ♦ 10 9 6 5 4 ♣ A 9 6		♠ 6 ♥ A J 10 9 7 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ 10 4 2
	♠ J 7 4 2 ♥ K Q 5 4 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 7 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 10 2 ♥ 5 3 2 ♦ 8 2 ♣ 9 8 5 3 2	
♠ A 6 4 ♥ K J 9 ♦ A K Q J 9 ♣ K Q		♠ J 3 ♥ A Q 10 8 6 ♦ 10 3 ♣ J 10 7 4
	♠ K 9 8 7 5 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 7 6 5 4 ♣ A 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

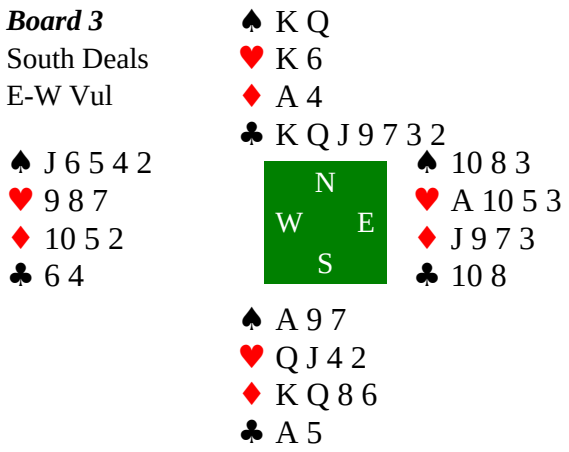
1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣A

EAST makes a positive 3♥ response to WEST's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♠4

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 ♥ Q 10 ♦ J 9 6 5 4 2 ♣ Q J 3 2	
♠ A K Q 6 4 3 ♥ K 5 ♦ K 7 3 ♣ A K		♠ J 9 5 2 ♥ A J 7 4 3 ♦ A Q ♣ 9 8
	♠ 10 7 ♥ 9 8 6 2 ♦ 10 8 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

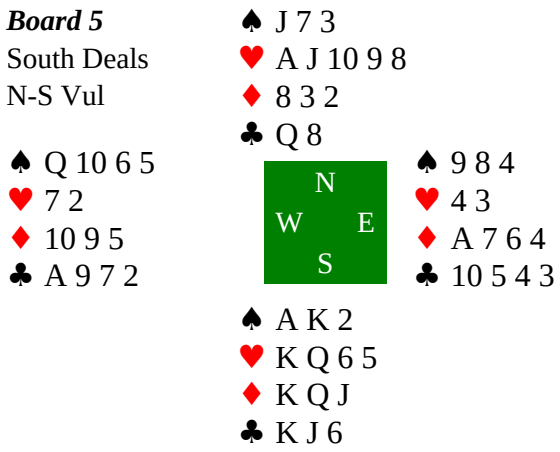
7NT by West
Lead: ♣Q

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by North
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 8 7 5 ♥ Q J 6 ♦ 8 2 ♣ A J 6 4	
♠ K Q 4 ♥ A 8 ♦ K Q J 10 7 3 ♣ K 5	N W E S	♠ A 6 3 ♥ K 10 7 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ Q 9 8 7
	♠ 10 9 2 ♥ 9 5 4 3 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ 10 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥5

WEST not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when EAST jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, WEST uses Gerber.

EAST shows two Aces so WEST decides 6NT will be just right.

Board 7
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 8 5 ♥ J 6 3 ♦ 8 7 ♣ A Q J 4	
♠ 10 7 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 8 6 3		♠ 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ K 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ 9 7 2
	♠ A J 9 6 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ A Q J 6 ♣ K 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	6♣[4]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦5

When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Board 8
East Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 3 2
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A 10 9 4 2

♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ —

♠ K Q J
♥ A K 10
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 8 5 3
♥ 6 5
♦ A 7 5
♣ J 8 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

EAST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but WEST gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

WEST then bids 3♠, showing first round control. EAST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and WEST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

EAST bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

Board 9
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ A K 10 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

♠ 10 9 7 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 10 4 2
♣ A Q 10 3

♠ Q J 6
♥ 9 2
♦ J 5
♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ —

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			

7♥ by North
Lead: ♦J

SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A J 9 8 6 4 ♥ 8 6 ♦ 10 7 ♣ A 8 5	
♠ — ♥ A 9 7 5 ♦ K 9 8 6 4 ♣ J 9 3 2	N W E S	♠ K 5 3 ♥ K Q J 10 3 ♦ A ♣ K Q 10 6
	♠ Q 10 7 2 ♥ 4 2 ♦ Q J 5 3 2 ♣ 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣7

EAST figures that if WEST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

WEST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

EAST manages to figure out that WEST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 5 3
♥ J 8 7
♦ A 8 6 5
♣ 7 4

♠ Q J
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10 9 4
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2

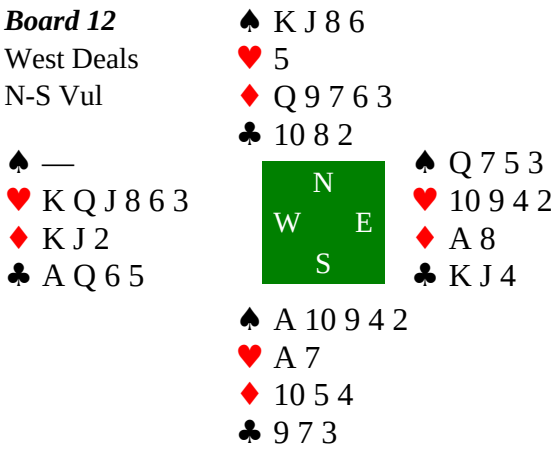
♠ A 9 8 6 4
♥ A K Q
♦ 7
♣ K J 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣10

SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♥5

WEST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and EAST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that EAST holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 6 2 ♥ A 10 9 ♦ A K 3 ♣ A K 8 4	
♠ Q J 8 5 ♥ 8 7 6 5 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ 5 2	N W E S	♠ 10 9 4 3 ♥ Q J 4 ♦ 10 ♣ Q J 10 9 3
	♠ A 7 ♥ K 3 ♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2 ♣ 7 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings

7NT by North
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 7 4 2 ♥ A 10 8 5 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 3 2	
♠ J 8 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 8 5 ♣ A K Q 10 9 6	N W E S	♠ A K Q ♥ K Q 6 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ J 8 7 5
	♠ 10 6 5 3 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A 9 7 6 4 2 ♣ 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT			
All Pass			

4NT by East
Lead: ♥9

WEST has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A Q 6 ♥ K 7 3 ♦ K 6 ♣ K 10 6 5 3	
♠ 9 4 3 ♥ A 8 5 4 ♦ J 7 4 2 ♣ 9 4	N W E S	♠ J 10 8 2 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ Q 10 5 ♣ J 8 2
	♠ K 7 5 ♥ Q 9 6 ♦ A 9 8 3 ♣ A Q 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 10 5 3 ♥ A 4 3 2 ♦ Q 10 9 2 ♣ 9 3	
♠ A 8 7 6 ♥ Q J 7 ♦ A J 3 ♣ A 8 2		♠ K Q J 4 ♥ K 6 ♦ K 4 ♣ K Q J 10 5
	♠ 9 2 ♥ 10 9 8 5 ♦ 8 7 6 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♠5

When WEST opens 1NT EAST hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K	
♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3		♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5
	♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♥[4]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by North
Lead: ♠Q

NORTH has a pretty good hand, and when SOUTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding SOUTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 18
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 9 3

♠ K 7
♥ K 9
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ A Q J 7

♠ A 6 2
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 7 5
♣ K 8 6 2

♠ Q 10 9 5
♥ Q 8 5 3
♦ 9 8 2
♣ 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♠	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

7NT by East
Lead: ♠10

WEST is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when EAST shows 13-15 points WEST wants to be in a slam.

WEST cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with EAST's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in WEST's hand so he bids 7NT.

Board 19
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ 7
♦ Q 10 6 5 3
♣ K 10 8 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2
♦ 2
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 10 9 7 2
♥ A Q J 6
♦ A 8
♣ 6 3

♠ 6
♥ K 4
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ A Q J 9 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 20
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 6 ♥ 7 2 ♦ Q 9 8 4 ♣ K Q 10 2	
♠ K 4 ♥ K Q 10 9 5 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A 5 4		♠ A Q J 7 3 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7
	♠ 8 5 2 ♥ 4 3 ♦ K J 10 2 ♣ J 9 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣K

WEST knows EAST has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, EAST comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces WEST knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

Board 21
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 10 9 5 2 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ A 4	
♠ 8 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ K J 10 7 2 ♣ 7 6 2		♠ Q J 10 9 ♥ 6 4 ♦ Q 8 5 3 ♣ 8 5 3
	♠ A 6 2 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	7♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings

7♥ by North
Lead: ♠Q

When SOUTH answers Blackwood with one Ace NORTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, SOUTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, NORTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, SOUTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 10 6 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 7 5 4	
♠ 8 7 ♥ Q 9 7 4 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ A 10 8 3		♠ A K Q 5 ♥ A J 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J
	♠ 9 4 3 ♥ K 3 ♦ J 10 9 8 2 ♣ 9 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

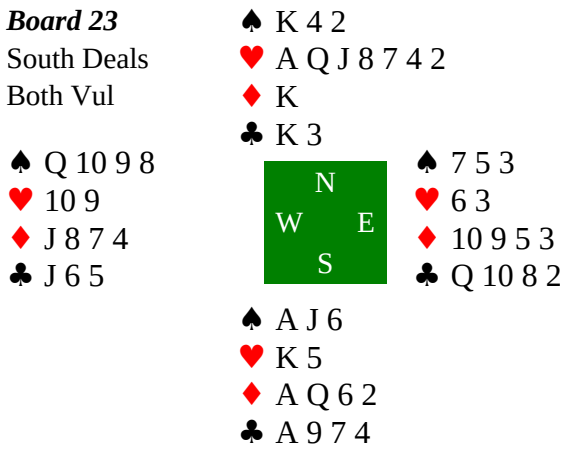
5♥ by East
Lead: ♣2

EAST thinks there might be slam if WEST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When WEST shows just one Ace EAST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that EAST might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

Board 23
South Deals
Both Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Board 24
East Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 4
♥ 9 8 5 3 2
♦ A 8 7
♣ 9 2

♠ Q 6 3
♥ A 10 7
♦ 9 5 2
♣ A 10 8 6

♠ A K
♥ K Q 4
♦ K Q J 3
♣ K Q J 5

♠ 10 8 7 5 2
♥ J 6
♦ 10 6 4
♣ 7 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♥8

WEST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

EAST only needs to know how many Aces are in the WEST hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When WEST shows two Aces EAST bids 6NT.